

ILKA GERHARDS

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Economics of Education, Health Economics, Applied Microeconometrics

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Assistant Professor (non-tenure track), LMU Munich *since 2022*
Seminar for Population Economics

MEMBERSHIPS & AFFILIATIONS

CESifo Affiliate Member *since 2022*

Member of SFB/ CRC TRR 190, Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft (DFG) *since 2017*

RESEARCH VISITS

Visiting Researcher *2025 April-May*
The University of Sydney, Sponsor: Stefanie Schurer

Visiting Researcher *2017 - 2018*
University of California Santa Barbara (UCSB), Sponsor: Shelly Lundberg

Visiting Graduate Student *2013 - 2014*
Universidad de Zaragoza (UNIZAR)

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics (Dr. oec. publ.), LMU Munich *2015 - 2022*
Thesis committee: Uwe Sunde, Joachim Winter, Ludger Wößmann
Evidence-Based Economics Graduate Program (EBE)

MSc in Economics, research track, LMU Munich *2012 - 2015*

BSc in Business Sciences and Economics, extra-occupational studies *2007 - 2012*
FernUniversität in Hagen (FeU)

SCHOLARSHIPS & DISTINCTIONS

Initiation of International Collaboration Grant, DFG (EUR 8,400) *2025*

Research grant, Junior Development Program LMU (EUR 28,700) *2022, 2024, 2025*

Joachim Herz Fellowship, for interdisciplinary research (EUR 12,500) *2019 - 2022*

SFB Travel Grant, DFG (EUR 6,800) *2017 - 2018, 2025*

Fulbright Scholarship, for a research stay at UCSB (EUR 12,100) *2017 - 2018*

Presentation at Lindau Meeting of the Laureates *2017*

Lecture Subsidy for Young Scientists, German Economic Association (EUR 500) *2016*

LMUMentoring/ LMUexcellent Scholarship, (EUR 5,900) *2015 - 2017*

Dissertation Scholarship, Elite Network of Bavaria *2015 - 2017*

LMU Anita-Augspurg-Prize , best master's thesis in Economics (EUR 300)	<i>2015</i>
Matrículas de Honor , best student tuition fee exemption at exchange university	<i>2014</i>
A-levels/ "Abitur" , best student of school's cohort	<i>2006</i>

RESEARCH

Advanced Work in Progress (post conference presentation stage)

Relative Age in the Classroom, Parental Choice, and Returns to Schooling

Class Composition Effects - Multigrade Classes for the Youngest (with Uwe Sunde & Larissa Zierow)

Class Composition and Educational Outcomes - Evidence from the Abolition of Denominational Schools (with Uwe Sunde & Larissa Zierow)

Just another Pill? The Health Consequences of Labor Induction - Evidence from Germany

The Effect of Peace Agreements on Conflict and Violence: The Case of Colombia (with John Michael Riveros Gavilanes & Uwe Sunde)

Early-stage Projects

Exposure to Environmental Heat In-utero and Later-life Returns to Schooling: Evidence from Germany (with Gregor Pfeifer)

Multi-Grade Teaching and Student Achievement: A Longer-Run Perspective (with Margarita Gatsou)

Medium-run Effects of Birth Interventions (with Naomi Gershoni & Hadar Goldshtein)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS & INVITED TALKS

2025: 17th dggö, Paderborn; USYD MPP Seminar; CHERE Seminar, University of Technology Sydney; SCoPE Workshop (USYD); CRC 16th Retreat, Ohlstadt; LMU-ifo Junior Faculty Retreat, Munich (sched.); Invited Talk WU, Vienna (sched.); LMU-NYU Workshop, Munich (subm.).

2024: CRC 14th Retreat, Schwanenwerder; ESPE, Rotterdam; LMU-ifo Junior Faculty Retreat, Munich; EALE, Bergen; CESifo Area Conference (Labor); VfS, Berlin.

2023: LMU-ifo Junior Faculty Retreat, Munich.

2022: CRC 11th Retreat, Tutzing; LMU-ifo Junior Faculty Retreat, Kochel.

2020: ifo Center Seminar 2020/Q2 (COVID cancellation); Joachim Herz Network Meeting (dto.).

2018: CRC 4th Retreat, Ohlstadt; UCSB Econometrics Research Group, Santa Barbara.

2017: UCSB Labor Seminar, Santa Barbara; 20th IZA Summer School, Ammersee; 3rd LEER Workshop Education Economics, Leuven; 10th RGS, Dortmund; Perspectives on (Un-)Employment, Nuremberg; Invited Talk at JKU, Linz.

2016: ESEM, Edinburgh; ifo Center Seminar, Munich; Early Childhood in Transition, Heidelberg; Efficiency in Education, Milan; MGSE Colloquium 2016, Munich; VfS, Augsburg; EBE Summer Meeting, Freising; Applied Economics of Education, Catanzaro; ESPE, Berlin; XIX Applied Economics, Seville; LMU NatEx Workshop, Ohlstadt; EBE Summer School, Ohlstadt.

TEACHING & MENTORING

Lectures & Seminars, LMU Munich

MSc-/PhD-level: Lecture “Applied (Macro-)Economics” *annual since 2022*

BSc-level: Advanced seminars on applied education and health economics (#4) *since 2023*

Tutorials, LMU Munich

MSc-level: Managerial Economics II *2017*

BSc-level: Grundlagen VWL II; Makroökonomie I/ II; Empirische Ökonomie II *2016-2022*

Mentoring, LMU Munich

PhD co-supervision as junior mentor (#2 since 2024); RA management (#9 since 2016);

BSc/ MSc thesis and seminar paper supervision (#19,#18,#67 since 2016)

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Applied Sector Networks & Data Acquisition

Collaboration with St. Ursula Educational Foundation (BISEF) *since 2020*

Service

Referee for EMEC, LABECO, JEBO *since 2023*

Co-/Assistant Organizer: EBE Jamboree; UNIZAR TS-Econometrics Workshop *2014, 2016*

WORK EXPERIENCE

Financial Administration

2018 - 2022

MGSE Graduate Program GRK 1928 (Carsten Eckel), LMU Munich

Research Assistance

CAS Center for Advanced Studies (Uwe Sunde), LMU Munich *2013 - 2015*

Econometrics Department Aragon Statistics Institute, Zaragoza *2014*

Consulting in Banking

LIGA Bank eG, Munich (credit transactions, construction financing, securities) *2010 - 2013*

Targobank eG, Munich (private loans) *2009 - 2010*

Citibank AG & Co KGaA, Dortmund (apprenticeship) *2006 - 2009*

SKILLS

Language German (native), English (TOEFL 113/120), Spanish (C2)

Computer R, Stata, ArcGIS, GitHub

Last updated: August 2025